

Flower partners

Just like you might prefer one drink to another, some animals will choose to drink nectar from certain plants. And these plants will try all sorts of tricks to attract their chosen pollinator.



Smelling right is as important as looking pretty.

Bee mine

Bee orchids look and smell like female bees to attract male bees. There are around 130 types of bee orchid in Europe that impersonate different kinds of bees.



Going batty

In the deserts of North America, long-nosed bats feed from century plants. The bat's thick fur picks up lots of pollen as it buries its head in the flower for a drink of nectar.

Perfect pairs

- A carpenter bee buzzes at the right pitch to shake loose the pollen of a gentian flower.
- The dead-horse arum stinks of rotting meat to attract blow-flies.
- Moths seek pale yellow or white flowers at night.



Fly-by feeder

Hummingbirds can access flowers that other birds cannot reach, because they are the only birds that can hover in mid-air. Flowers that want to attract birds are usually coloured red.